

Teaching language components

Grammar-functions-vocabulary

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01

Introduction

02

How to teach grammar

03

How to teach functions

04

How to teach vocabulary

05

Conclusion

Agenda

What we'll discuss today

THE CENTRAL QUESTION

**How can we make to some
extent a person master the
language?**

DISCUSSION

Agree or Disagree

Reflect on the relationship between vocabulary and grammar in language learning.

- 01 Vocabulary **cannot be separated** from the learning of the grammar of the language?
- 02 **Thematic units** help students learn words and groups of words?
- 03 Vocabulary has been **widely overlooked** recently on the expense of grammar in the EFL classrooms?
- 04 Linguistically: **Without grammar, little can be conveyed, but without vocabulary nothing can?**
- 05 Certain grammar structures lend themselves to a study of **words and phrases**?

The Didactic Triad

Teacher • Learner • Knowledge

The Content Node

Symbiotic relationship

Vocabulary

The "bricks" of meaning

Grammar

The "mortar" that structures

Functions

The intent & purpose

Teacher balances all three

Communicative Competence

A. Linguistic Competence

Grammar + Vocabulary = **Accuracy**

Syntax, morphology, phonology, collocations

B. Sociolinguistic Competence

Functions = **Appropriacy**

Function: Requesting

Friend: "Give me a pen"

Director: "I was wondering if I might borrow a pen"

Context dictates vocabulary & grammar choice

Dell Hymes • Canale & Swain

The Integrated Building

Purpose-driven interaction



Vocabulary

The Material



Grammar

The Blueprint



Functions

The Architecture's Purpose

How to Teach Grammar



"Even kings bow down to grammar"

by
Molière

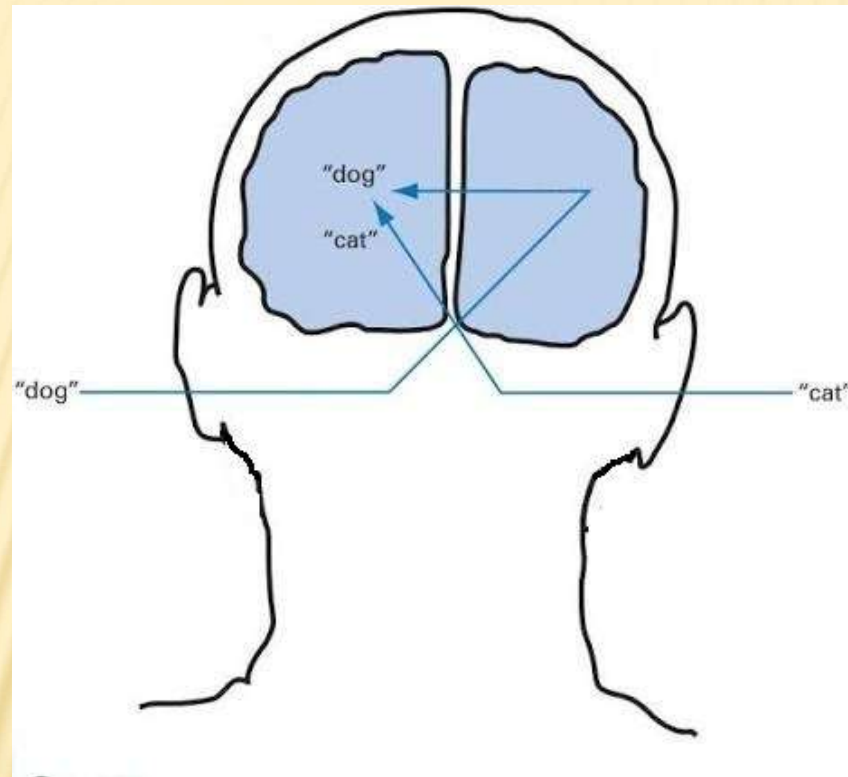
Definition of grammar according to Victoria Fromkin and Robert Rodman

“Grammar is the knowledge speakers have about the units and rules of their language, rules for combining sounds into words, rules of word formation, rules for combining words into phrases and phrases into sentences as well as rules for assigning meaning. The grammar, together with a mental dictionary that lists the words of the language, represents our linguistic competence.”

Ø **Cutting-edge scientific evidences for teaching grammar**

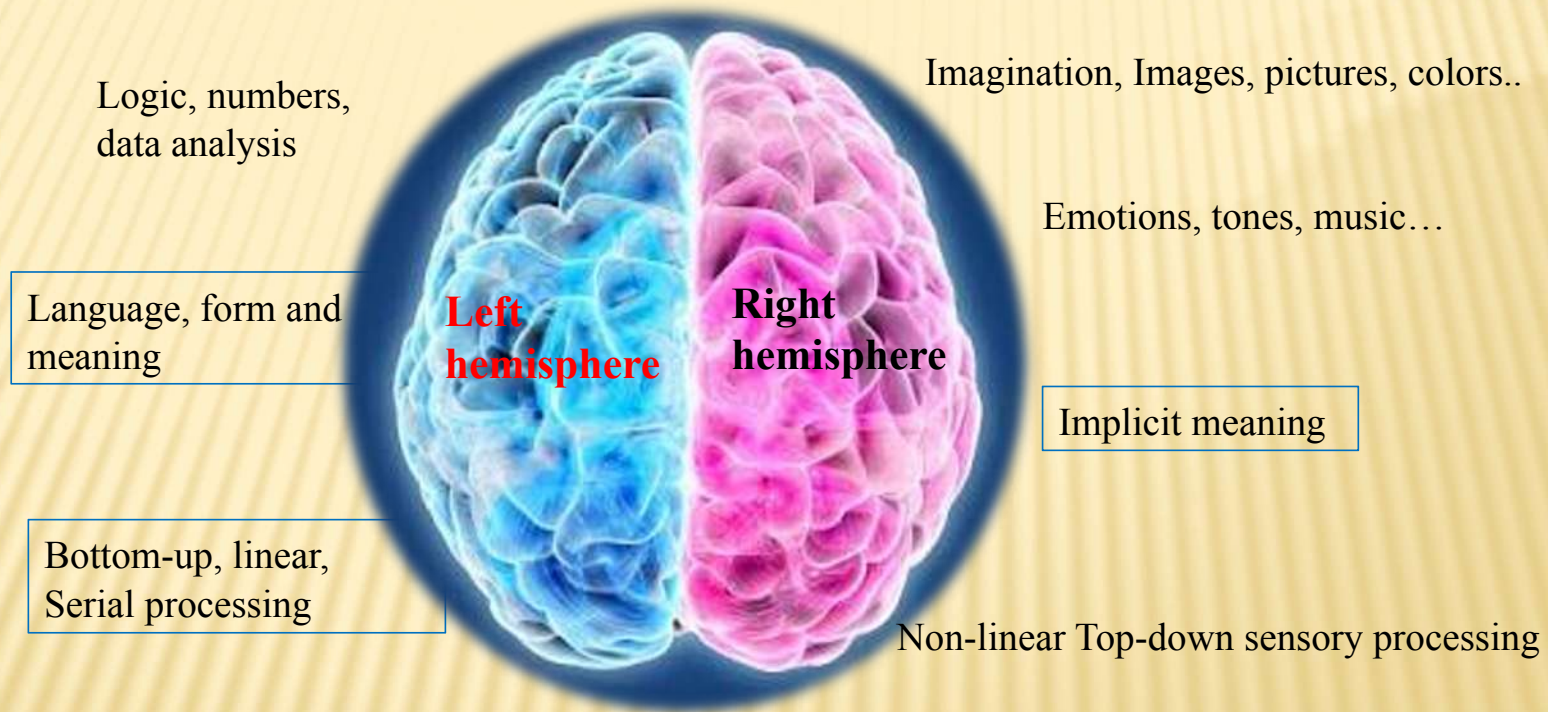
Ø **Reflection on language teaching methods in view of grammar teaching**

Ø **Demonstrative lesson**



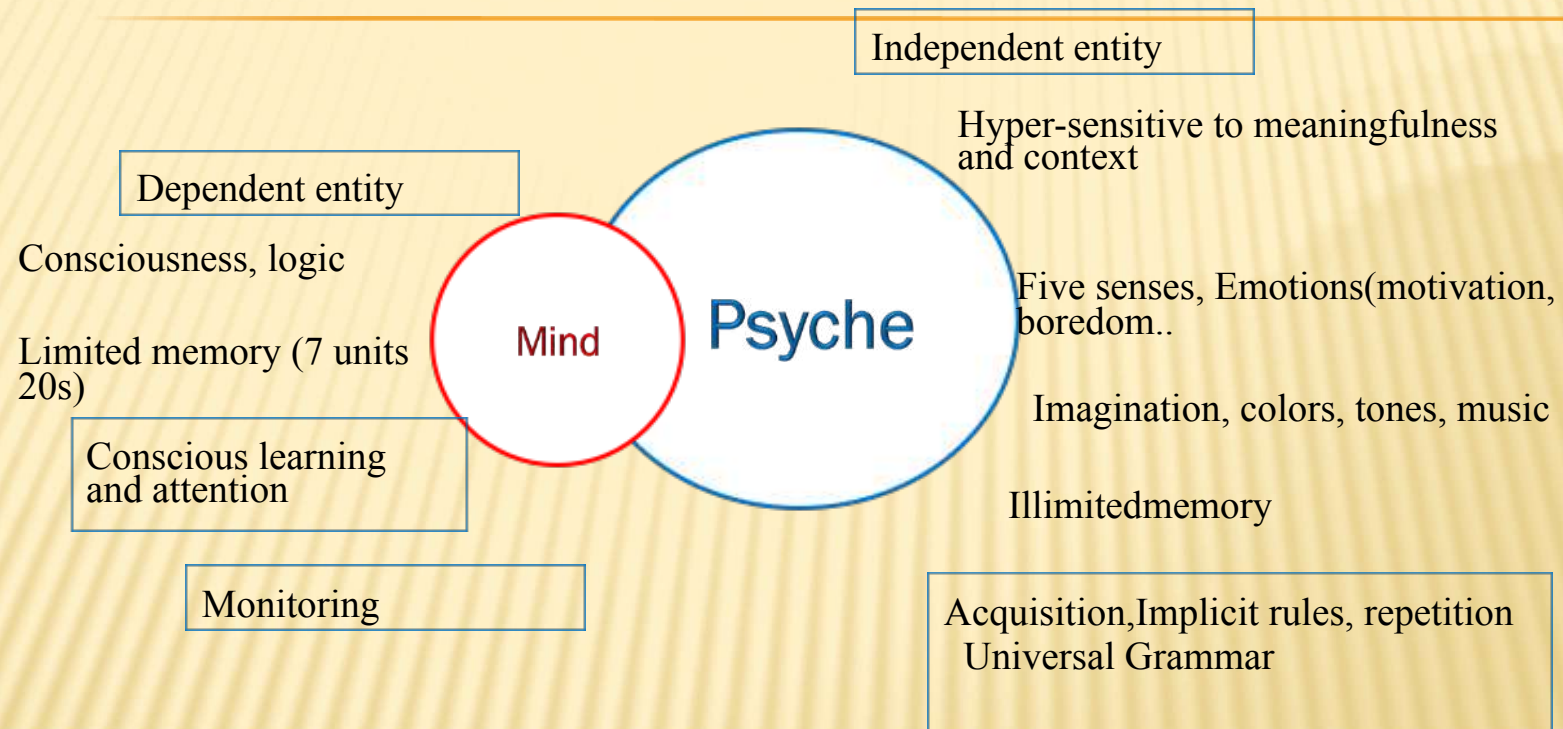
Scientific foundations

Understanding hemispheric specialization



- Ø Mustapha Mahmud, The Miracles of The Brain (part 1&2)
- Ø Biology of the Mind, Michael Gazzaniga, 5th edition

Psychological perspective



- Ø The Holy Quran, (chapters including verses on the psyche, 39/42, 17/40; 21/50, 105/11, 100/10.... Bruce
- Ø Lipton, The Biology of Belief, lecture on Youtube Cognitive Psychology, Robert Sternberg, 7thedition
- Ø

Insights Gained for Teaching grammar

- v Whole brain engagement = mind-psyche engagement
- v Contextualization of teaching materials
- v Meaningful, authentic tasks for learning
- v Avoid fictitious language and mechanical repetition in teaching
- v Motivation is a key-component in teaching grammar
- v Respect working memory load

Analytical and Synthetic Methods

*“Second language teaching methods fall into two broad categories: **the synthetic approach** and **the analytical approach**. As the name implies, the synthetic approach stresses the teaching of the grammatical, lexic, phonological, and functional units of the language step by step. This is a bottom-up method”*

“Analytical approaches are more top-down. The goal is not to explicitly

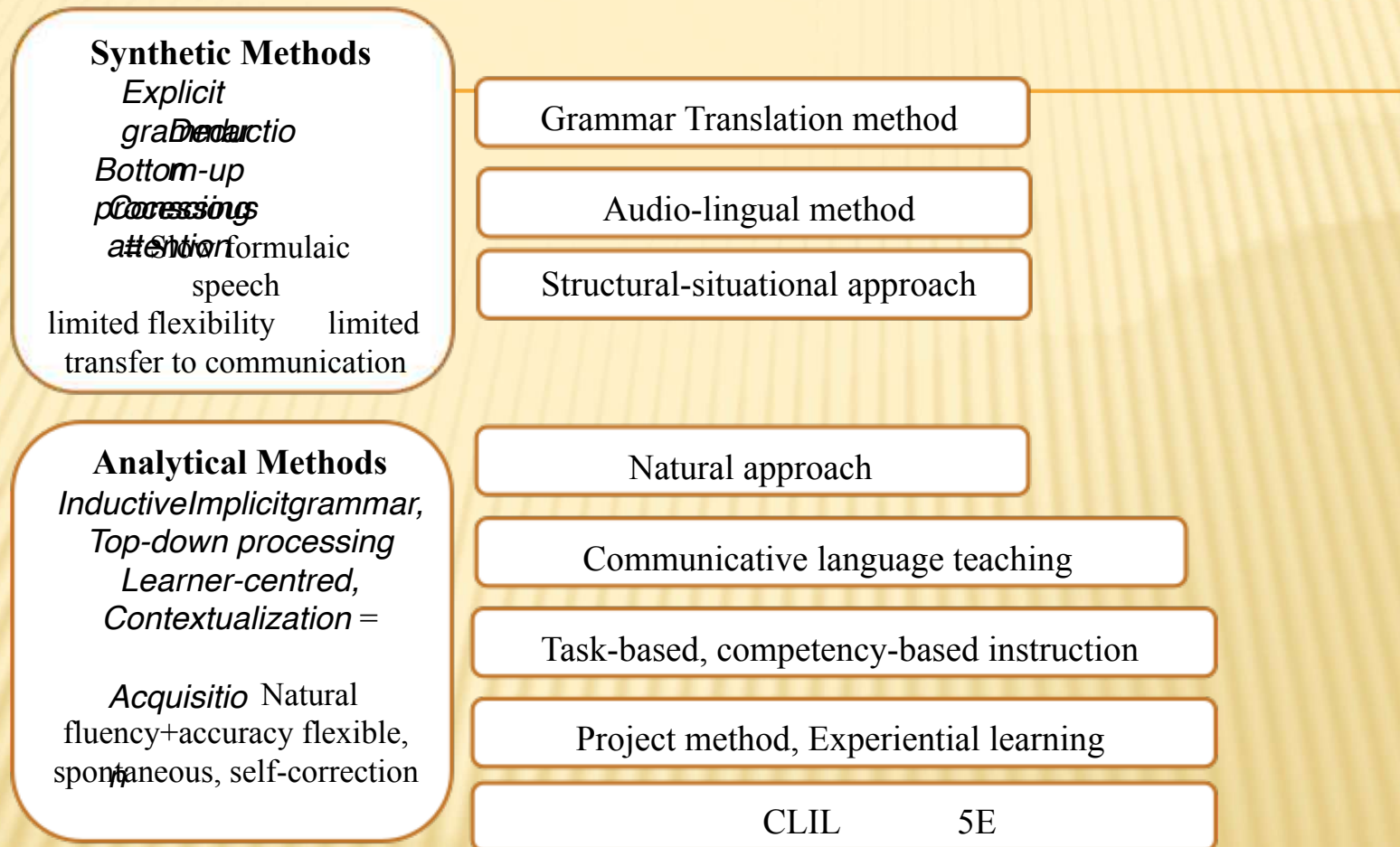
teach

the component parts or rules of the target language. Rather, the instructor

selects topics, texts, or tasks that are relevant to the needs and interests of the learner, whose job then is to discover the constituent parts of the language.”

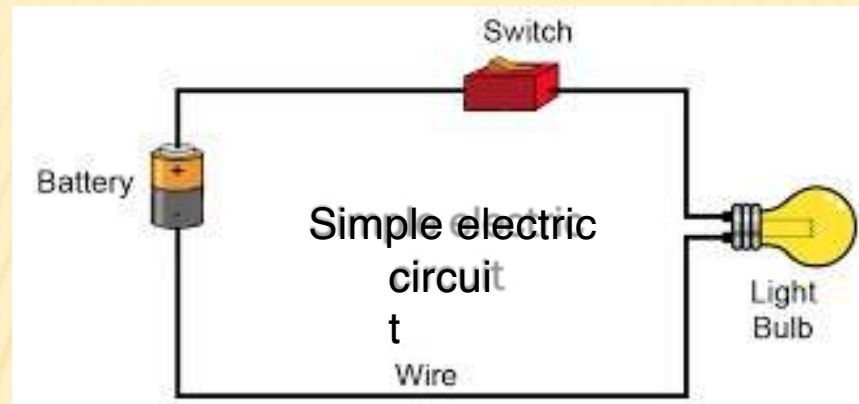
The synthetic and analytical approach should be viewed as the opposite of the learner, whose job then is to discover the constituent parts of the language. a continuum along which various second-language methods may fall. In

addition, teachers practicing a given method may not strictly follow all the principles of the method.”



- Ø An Introduction to Language, 11th edition Teaching by Principles, Douglas Brown, 2nd edition
- Ø Approaches and Methods in Language Teaching, Jack C. Richards and Theodore Rogers, 2nd edition
- Ø

Demonstrative Lesson



Objectives:

- **Name** electrical elements, **indicate** the function of each
- (achieved) additional type 0 (if clause and main clause)

Presentation Stage

If I ~~cut~~ the wire, light bulb ~~stops~~.

Light bulb ~~stops~~ if I ~~cut~~ the wire.

I ~~put~~ short wires, light bulb **works**.

Light bulb **works** if I ~~put~~ short wires.

Controlled Practice

Complete correctly: put-put-dim-becomes-if

_____ I _____ two batteries, light _____ bright.

_____ you _____ two light bulbs, light _____ dim.

Free Practice

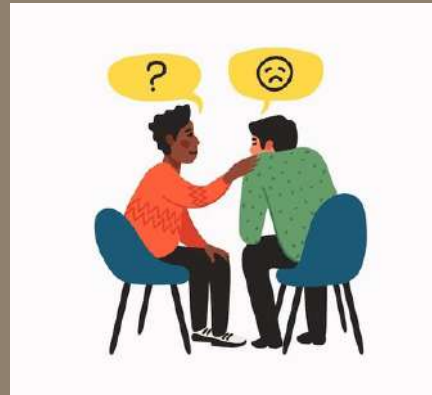
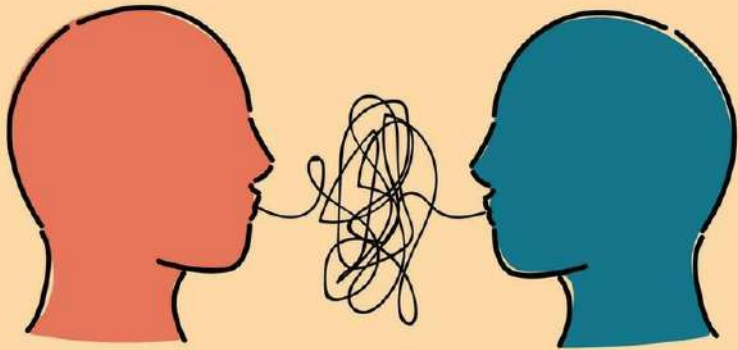
Complete the sentences:

1. There is no electricity.
remove the battery.

If _____, _____
_____ if _____

2. Put alluminium wires.
light bulb works.

If _____, _____
_____ if _____



How to teach functions



Today's lesson: Saying I'm "sorry"

level: middle school (A1/
A2)

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By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

1. Understand the difference between a small problem and a big problem.
2. Apologize using "Sorry," "I'm sorry," and "I'm very sorry."
3. Respond to an apology using "That's OK" or "No problem."

Big problems/ Small problems

(creating a strong context)

You lie to your parents.

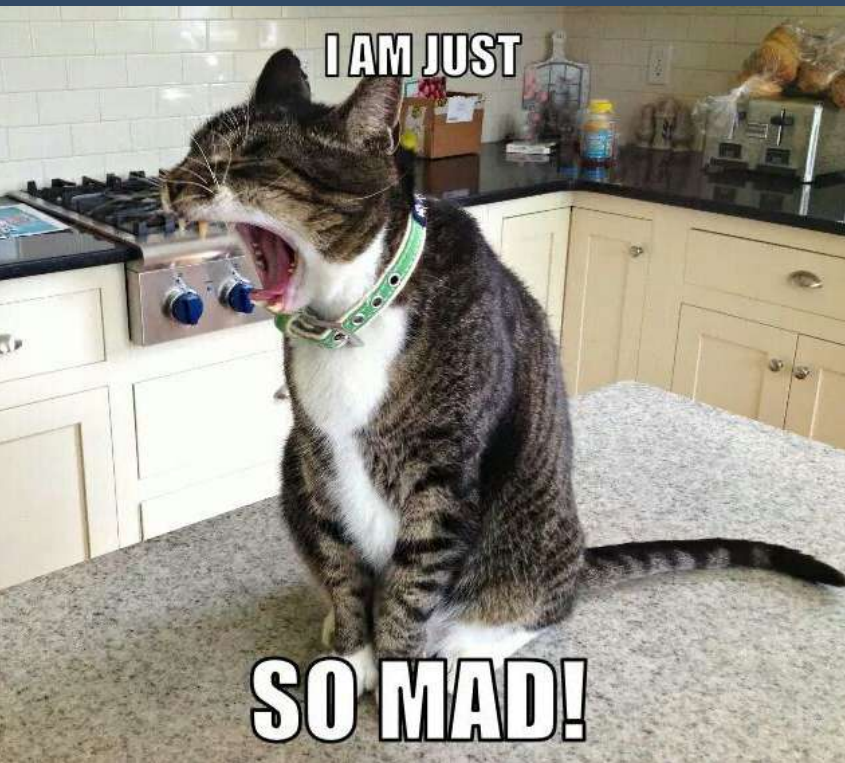
You step on someone's shoe.

You break your friend's new phone.

You are 2 minutes late to class.

You forget your mom's request.

Small problem=simple
sorry=simple reply



Big problem=Big sorry=
serious reply

Chant it

(providing vocabulary)

Small sorry

oops!
repeat
sorry
repeat

Replies

That's OK
repeat

Big sorry

I'm so sorry
repeat
I'm very sorry
repeat

Replies

no problem
repeat
I forgive you
repeat

Let's play (*practice*)

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Activity: "Sorry Toss"



The teacher begins by tossing a soft ball to a student while simultaneously presenting a simple situation, such as "You have my pen." The student must catch the ball and respond with an appropriate apology, like "Oh, sorry!" before tossing the ball to a classmate and providing a new situation for them to react to.



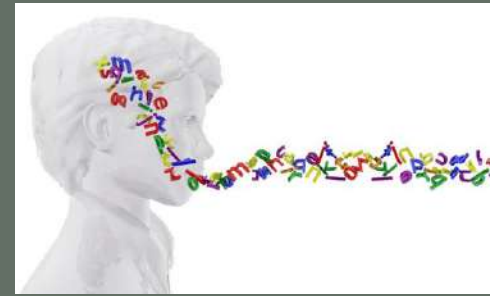
Meaning

one form could have different meaning.
different forms could have one meaning



Form

There are a lot of forms in functions, and we need to know what comes after and what would be the appropriate reply or answer.



Pronunciation

we need to think about connected speech, sentence stress, intonations. This is really important as it can effect the meaning.

Teaching a language, MFP (meaning-form-pronunciation) is still fundamental.

To teach functions

you have to...

create a strong context

provide vocabulary and different forms

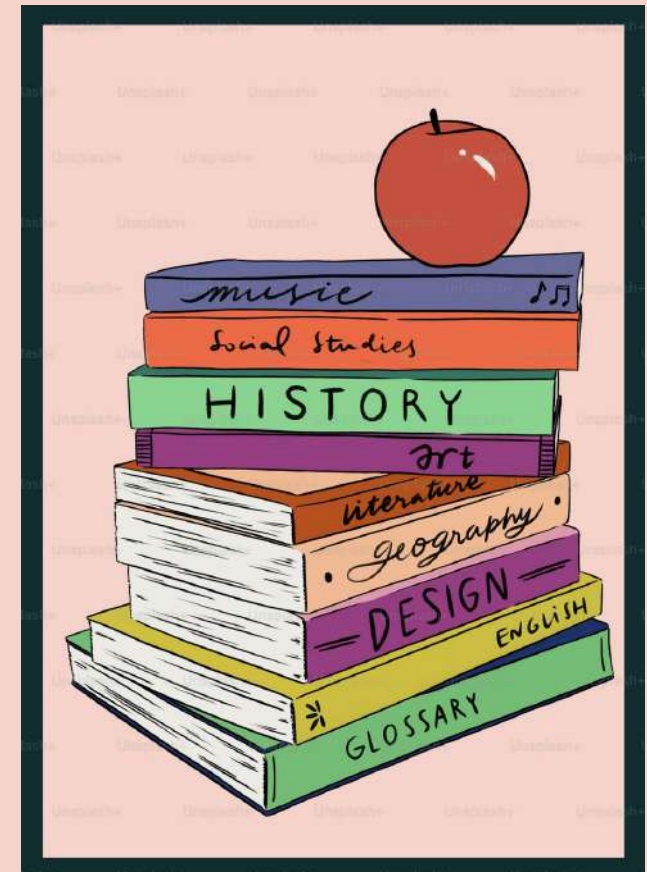
provide practice activities and tasks (pair work/role play/
board dialogue with gaps....)

HOW TO TEACH VOCABULARY: CLASSROOM VOCABULARY



Importance Of Teaching Vocabulary

- Vocabulary is essential for communication.
- It supports reading, writing, listening, and speaking.
- Students need to know not only the **meaning** but also the form, pronunciation, and **use** of words.



Lesson Example: Teaching Classroom Vocabulary

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Level: Middle School (A1–A2 level)

Topic: Vocabulary related to the classroom (objects and places)

Lesson Objectives:

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

1. Identify and name common classroom objects (e.g., desk, board, ruler, eraser, notebook).
2. Use classroom vocabulary correctly in simple sentences
3. Understand and respond to classroom instructions using new vocabulary.

Stage I – Presentation

- Use real objects, pictures, or flashcards.
- Model pronunciation and spelling.
- Give examples in context.



Stage II – Practice

Matching words to pictures.



● Bag



● Ruler



● Whiteboard



● Pen

Fill in the Blanks

Use the words: **pen** – **bag** – **whiteboard** – **ruler**

1. I write with my _____.
2. The teacher writes on the _____.
3. I keep my books in my _____.
4. I use a _____ to draw straight lines.

Put the Letters in the Correct Order

1. g a b → _____
2. p e n → _____
3. l e r u r → _____
4. b e a d i w h o r t → _____

Stage III – Production

Possible Activities:

- Describe their classroom.
- Work in pairs or groups.
- Use vocabulary creatively.



To Teach Vocabulary

You Have To:

- **Teach vocabulary in context.**
- **Use the 3 steps: Present – Practice – Produce.**
- **Use visuals, repetition, and interaction.**
- **Focus on meaning, pronunciation, and use.**



CONCLUSION

Beyond Linguistic Components

Vocabulary, grammar, and functions alone are not enough

While grammar, functions, and vocabulary constitute the **essential DNA** of a language, they do not equal mastery.

"The ability to use language requires not just control of linguistic form but awareness of rules of use." — Hymes (1972)

The Four Competences

- Linguistic (Grammar + Vocabulary)
- Sociolinguistic (Functions)
- Discourse Competence
- Strategic Competence

— Canale & Swain (1980)

To Truly Master a Language:

Strategic & Discourse Competence

Navigate misunderstandings;
organize coherent communication

Sociocultural Awareness

Understand unwritten cultural
rules of appropriacy

Higher-Order Thinking

Analyze, evaluate, create —
beyond simple recall

Pragmatic Competence *"The ability to use language effectively to achieve specific purposes and understand language in context" — Thomas (1983)*

Interactional Competence Using linguistic resources through turn-taking, repair, and speech acts in real-world situations

Our Goal: Not just teach the "bricks and mortar," but empower students to become **architects** of their own communication.

SUMMARY

Key Takeaways

01 Insufficiency of Linguistic Components

Vocabulary, grammar, and functions alone cannot achieve total language mastery

02 Beyond Linguistic Knowledge

Mastery requires pragmatic competence, interactional competence, and sociocultural awareness

03 Critical Competences

Strategic and discourse competence navigate communication; higher-order thinking creates meaning

04 The Educator's Role

Empower students to become architects of their own communication

"Language is a social and emotional bridge – mastery is achieved through authentic connections"

A FINAL REFLECTION

If language is a bridge between minds
and hearts, are we teaching our
students to *build bridges* — or merely to
understand blueprints?

"The measure of language education is not in the grammar mastered
or vocabulary memorized, but in the *authentic connections created*
and the *unique identities expressed*."

"We teach not just language, but **communication** — not just correctness, but **connection**."

THANK YOU

Any Questions?

We appreciate your time and attention.

